Market Audit, Marketing Research and Pricing

for a Speech & Confident Communication School in Nitra, Slovakia

Semester project: feasibility study (no real-life implementation)

Item	Details
Course	1MM22b
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Business idea	Online and offline school of public speaking and confident speech
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Part A. Structure

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Part B. Section Templates

Public speaking anxiety is a widely reported barrier across academic and professional fields. This study, conducted as a school project, examines the demand for a public speaking course in Nitra, Slovakia, and identifies the market segment it should target. An online survey collected responses from a dozen participants, mostly university students, covering self-assessed confidence, reported difficulties, preferred course format, and price sensitivity. Three key findings emerged. First, fear or anxiety and speaking in a non-native language were the most frequently cited difficulties, while average self-assessed confidence was moderate (3.2 of 5). Second, respondents preferred a group format (6–12 people) delivered as a 4–8 week course meeting once a week, mainly in hybrid or offline settings. Third, demand is tangible: the mean intention to enrol within 12 months was high (4.0 of 5). Regarding pricing, participants considered roughly €15–20 "too cheap" and €90+ "too expensive", indicating a recommended course price of about €40–50 and individual sessions at €6–10 per hour. The main limitation is the small, homogeneous convenience sample (n = 6), which restricts generalizability.

1. Introduction

- **1.1 Business idea**.

  The business idea is "Speak UP", a school of confident public speaking operating in both offline and online formats, which will provide a range of services for developing speech and presentation skills. The school will be based in Nitra, Slovakia, offering hybrid delivery: in-person group sessions supplemented by online lessons for greater accessibility. The core product is a group course (6–12 participants) of 4–8 weeks, meeting once a week, as preferred by the survey respondents. Courses will be delivered in four languages widely spoken in Slovakia: Slovak, English, Ukrainian, and Russian.

- **1.2 Why this topic.**

  The topic was chosen because of the growing demand for soft skills in the modern labour market: employers increasingly value communication, presentation, and public speaking abilities alongside technical knowledge.

- **1.3 Research objective:**

  Assess whether a multilingual speech school in Nitra is feasible and determine a justified price per service.

- **1.4 Research questions** (example):
  - RQ1: How large and attractive is the market for speech and confidence training in Nitra and online in the four languages?
  - RQ2: Who are the main customer segments and what do they need and want to pay?
  - RQ3: Who are the competitors and what are their prices and gaps?
  - RQ4: What price per service is justified by costs, competition and customer value?

2. Methodology

Method	Scope (reduced for 1 week)	Tool	Used for
Secondary (desk) research	Statistics	Google Trends	Section 3
Competitor analysis	6–8 competitors	Websites, social media, price lists	Sections 3, 6
Online survey	10 respondents	Google Forms	Sections 4, 6

3. Market Audit

Politically, Slovakia is an EU and eurozone member with a stable business environment and EU support for adult education. Economically, the Nitra Region has a strong industrial labour market (automotive, engineering). Socially, Nitra is a multilingual environment — Slovak majority plus Ukrainian, Russian, and English-speaking communities — and speaking in a non-native language was the most common difficulty among survey respondents, which supports the different language concept. Technologically, video-conferencing tools, LMS platforms, and social media make hybrid and online delivery cheap to launch. Legally, training services require only a standard trade licence under the Slovak Trade Licensing Act No. 455/1991 Coll., with standard consumer protection and invoicing rules applying to paid courses.

3.2 Market size

Base data. Nitra has approximately 78,000 inhabitants and the Nitra Region about 662,000 (Statistical Office data, 2025). The city is an academic centre with two universities — Constantine the Philosopher University and the Slovak University of Agriculture — with about 14,000 students combined. The Nitra District employs an average of around 60,000 people, with the labour market centred on industry. According to IOM, foreigners make up 5.13% of Slovakia's population; the largest groups are Ukrainians (156,881 persons) and Russians (7,436 persons); there is no official statistics on English-speaking residents, but English serves as the main language of expats and international students.

TAM — all potential learners in Slovakia plus the online market.

SAM — the realistically reachable market: about 14000 students in Nitra, the young professional segment of the city and region, approximately 164000 Ukrainian- and Russian-speaking residents of Slovakia, and online learners who search for courses in the four languages — estimated at roughly 100,000–150,000 people.

SOM — the realistic first-year share: assuming one trainer runs four group cohorts per year (8–12 participants each) plus individual sessions, Speak UP can serve about 150–250 learners in year 1. This is well below 0.5% of SAM, which is a conservative assumption given the survey's high enrolment intention (4.0 of 5) and the absence of direct low-cost competitors. At €40–50 per course this corresponds to roughly €8000–12000 of first-year revenue from group courses.

3.3 Demand analysis

Demand was analysed using Google Trends data for three queries: "best online public speaking course", "speak with confidence course", and "communication skills training online" (mid-2021 to mid-2026). All three queries show a rising trend, indicating growing interest in online speech training. Demand is clearly seasonal, with annual peaks every July, likely linked to the end of the academic year and autumn planning. The queries differ in nature: "communication skills training online" shows the highest, year-round interest, while the other two are episodic long-tail queries used mainly by people close to a purchase decision.

3.4 Competitor analysis

Competitor	Location	Format	Languages	Programs	Price (EUR)	Strengths / weakness
School of Confidence	Singapore	Offline, small groups (max 6 students per teacher)	Eng	Public speaking for kids 5–16, free trial, school partnerships	Not published	S: strong kids' specialization, MOE-certified trainers; W: children only, one market

Competitor	Location	Format	Languages	Programs	Price (EUR)	Strengths / weakness
School of Public Speaking (Instagram)	Middle East	Offline/online basics, *promoted via Instagram*	Eng	Basic public speaking courses	Not published	S: strong social-media-driven marketing; W: limited public information, no structured website or curriculum
Quiet Confidence	Australia (Sydney)	Offline weekly classes, holiday workshops, school workshops	Eng	Speaking classes for children, school support	Not published	S: school partnerships, community feel; W: kids only, local, no online offer
Public Speaking Academy	Singapore	Offline group classes + 2-day intensives	Eng	Kids 7–18 and adults; founded by 2016 World Champion of Public Speaking	Not published (premium positioning)	S: world-champion brand, tested curriculum, kids and adults; W: premium pricing, English only
Toastmasters International	Worldwide (13,800+ clubs, incl. Slovakia)	Club meetings + online Pathways platform	Eng *(local clubs in other langs)*	Peer-to-peer practice, structured learning paths, mentoring	~€65 per 6 months + one-time €23	S: cheapest option, global network, learn-by-doing; W: no professional trainer, no structured course, requires self-discipline
Preply (independent tutors)	Worldwide	Online individual lessons	Multiple *(average 2 per tutor)*	1:1 public speaking coaching, interview preparation	~€20–70/hour, average ~€33	S: flexible, any language, low entry price; W: variable quality, no group dynamics, no certificate

3.5 SWOT and attractiveness conclusion

Key insight. Competitors cluster in two groups: premium specialist schools and budget peer practice. In the European region, none of the analysed competitors offers a structured group course below €20 per hour. This leaves a gap for Speak UP: a structured group course in four languages at €40–50 per course (€7–10 per hour), which no competitor replicates.

However, the absence of low-cost competitors may also indicate that the actual market size in Nitra is limited — this remains the key open question of the research and should be tested with a larger survey.

4. Marketing Research

4.1 Target segments

The primary target segment of "Speak UP" is young people aged 17–24, mainly university bachelor students in Nitra, who experience fear of public speaking and difficulty speaking in a foreign language. Their needs are structured around studies — presentations, thesis defence, and job interviews — and their confidence in front of an audience is moderate.

4.2 Survey

Link for google forms survey "**Demand for Public Speaking and Confident Communication Courses in Nitra**": https://forms.gle/MzMnWy3BBdgZrR9dA

Link for results of the survey in format of .csv: https://drive.google.com/file/d/1I_ftJPUPpjtnlKVs62D_HJdRVwT-6kaQ/view?usp=sharing

4.5 Conclusions

The research confirms that the Speak UP school of confident speech is a viable business idea for Nitra. The demand is real: survey respondents rated their public speaking confidence at only 3.2 of 5, and their intention to enrol within 12 months was high (4.0 of 5), with the strongest difficulties being fear or anxiety and speaking in a non-native language.

Part D. Sources to Use

- Link for results of the survey in format of .csv: https://drive.google.com/file/d/1I_ftJPUPpjtnlKVs62D_HJdRVwT-6kaQ/view?usp=sharing
- Web-sites of companies:

a. https://schoolofconfidence.net/
b. https://www.instagram.com/school.of.public.speaking/
c. https://quietconfidence.au/
d. https://publicspeakingacademy.com.sg/2024/03/21/a-school-of-confidence-public-speaking-classes-for-kids-age-7-18-adults
e. https://www.toastmasters.org/about/
f. https://preply.com/en/online/public-tutors/

- Google trends, analyze via R:
  https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/11faDBMXkxaHj26cDKKWi1v5JwdbDc0Pm?usp=sharing